And So They Did

By V. McQuin

INTRODUCTION

Now, finally, at last - those old fairy tales have been exposed for the drivel they are! Did you ever stop to think that Sleeping Beauty might have been neutralized because she was a miserable young woman? Or that Goldilocks wore red because her mother got a great deal on a bolt of red cloth? Or even that those dragon fights were rigged?

Okay, I still love fairy tales, but you realize that the Grimm Brothers and the other famous story tellers wrote stories with plots that would never hold up today.

V McQuin tells it the way it really was - before those interfering writers went and changed the stories to be politically correct. And So They Did by V. McQuin

Narrator: Once upon a time a queen had triplets.

King: Three! Three?

Midwife: Three.

Narrator: And so there were.

King: Boys?

Midwife: Girls.

Narrator: And so they were. The queen named them April, May, and June.

Narrator: As the years passed, the three little princesses grew into beautiful young women. One day the king said,

King: It is time for you to think of marrying. And wedding gowns, and wedding feasts, and wedding balls. Not to mention princes. And there is the problem. You see, there is a slight shortage of princes this year.

Princesses: A shortage of princes?

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King: I'm afraid so. There were some very fine princes, but it appears they've all been taken. One was swept up by a cleaning girl!

Princesses: A cleaning girl?

King: A cleaning girl, named Cinder-something-or-other. Very nice and a hard worker, too. They said she only had rags to wear. Except for a pair of glass slippers. But she took the prince anyway. Another prince found some enchanted castle. Those are rather rare these days, but you do still find one every now and again. Seems everyone had been asleep for years, including the king's daughter, a real beauty. Without even knowing the girl the prince fell in love. Woke her with a kiss.

Princesses: A kiss! A kiss?

King: You know magic spells. If you can't think of anything else to break them, a kiss will usually do the trick. Anyway, that prince was married before everyone could finish yawning. Another prince fell helplessly in love with a dead girl.

Princesses: With a *dead* girl? How frightful!

King: She wasn't really dead. Another magic spell, you see. Her stepmother was a real witch. She couldn't stand the poor girl and put a curse on her. Everyone thought she was dead. She was so beautiful they kept her in a glass coffin. Good thing, too. The prince wandered by and fell in love. A kiss did the trick again. One more prince taken. Lovely for them, but you see it creates a problem for us.

Princesses: It's a problem, all right.

Narrator: Princess April stood up.

April: I will go and find a prince myself!

King: Find a prince yourself? Unheard of! Quite improper.

April: I'm sure I can! If a cleaning girl can find a prince, how hard can it be?

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King: Well… I've heard a prince or two might be left in the northern countries. You could try there, I suppose.

April: I will leave at once.

Narrator: And so she did.

King: What of you, May? Will you seek out your prince, too?

May: I hope you and mother won't mind terribly, but I'd really rather not find a prince at all.

King: Not at all? Unthinkable! Have you lost your mind?

May: Not at all. I've never much liked being a princess. I'd prefer to be an ordinary sort of person and work in the gardens.

King: Well… I suppose two princesses are enough for any castle.

May: And there's a nice young man who works in the garden. I believe he would marry me if you said he could.

Narrator: And so they did.

King: Well, then, June, what of you?

June: Oh, I think I'll put an ad in the paper.

King: An ad! In the paper?

June: I'm quite happy being a princess, but I don't want the hassle of searching for a prince. Therefore, I shall put an ad in the *Castle Times.* The ad will read: "Wanted: A prince to marry. Preferably handsome and rich. Must be wise and kind. Apply in person to Princess June."

King: Well… it's worth a try. Perhaps.

June: Sooner or later, a nice prince will answer my ad. Until then, I'm quite content to wait.

King: Very well, write your ad.

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Narrator: And so she did. It was not long before Princess April returned to the castle with a charming prince.

King: Now, then, April, tell us how you found this fellow.

April: It wasn't easy, Father. I traveled north until I reached a castle. A queen and her son lived in it, but they wouldn't even talk about marriage. "Spend the night and we'll talk in the morning," the queen said. The room was nice enough, but oh, the bed! I needed a ladder to climb into it. And was it ever lumpy! I couldn't sleep a bit. I figured that since I was awake, and the prince didn't seem very eager to marry me, I might as well move on. So I did. Of course, it was terribly dark out. I could not see a thing. I ran right into the side of another castle. When I rang the bell, a horrid beast came to the door!

King: A beast! A horrid beast? Shocking.

April: It was dreadful. You can be sure I didn't stick around to find a prince there! I ran away as quickly as I could in the dark. Suddenly I splashed right into a smelly pond. A poor frog talked to me. Or at least he tried. He had a raspy voice-hard to understand. I was tired, frightened, and soaked-I didn't have time to listen to a croaky old frog.

King: That may have been a good time to try a kiss.

April: A kiss! Hmmm… I never thought to kiss a *frog!*

Queen: Not to worry, my dear. You've a prince now. Do tell us how you got him.

April: Oh yes. In the morning, I wandered farther north. The snow was very deep. I was freezing, not to mention tired and hungry. I had almost decided to go home and let my prince find me. Then I saw him! He was so tall, so handsome, and so marvelous that I almost didn't know he was made of ice!

King: Of ice! He was made of ice?

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April: Indeed! He was enchanted, of course. By a wicked stepmother. You know how it is.

King: And you thawed him out?

April: A kiss did the trick, just as you said. As soon as he stopped dripping, we hurried here to be married.

Queen: Everything is almost ready for the wedding. While you were away, we worked day and night to prepare your wedding feast, ball, and gowns.

April: Gowns?

King: May has arranged to marry a young man who works in the gardens.

April: In the gardens! May is marrying a gardener?

King: Of course, he isn't just a gardener. He's a prince as well. Wicked stepfather, curses, and all that. A kiss did the trick once more. We can have a triple wedding as soon as a suitable prince answers June's ad.

April: Ad! June has placed an ad for a prince?

Narrator: Just then, the bell rang.

King: Lower the drawbridge!

Narrator: Princess June opened the door. She saw no one. Just as she turned to go back inside, she heard a very small laugh.

June: Hello?

Tom Thumb: Ha! Tricked you, didn't I?

Narrator: A very small man popped out of a crack between the paving stones. He was riding a mouse. Tom Thumb at your service. I'm here about the ad. May I speak to Princess June, please?

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June: Why… I am Princess June, but I'm afraid you are not quite what I was hoping for. You're much too small, and… I… well, I'm afraid of mice. I'm sorry, but you just won't do.

Tom Thumb: Oh well, it was worth a try. I guess I'll be off. Good day!

Narrator: Tom Thumb hopped into his saddle and spurred the mouse away.

King: Well?

June: It was a very odd little man, only as big as your thumb, His horse was a mouse! I doubt he's really a prince. Oh, there's the bell again. Perhaps this will be my prince.

Narrator: The drawbridge was lowered again. Princess June opened the door-and slammed it shut.

King: Well?

Queen: A kiss wouldn't help?

June: Absolutely not! The ad must have gotten into the *Jungle Times* by mistake. It was a lion.

King: A lion! Beastly! I knew that ad was a mistake.

June: Perhaps you're right. But the lion's gone now. And look, someone else is coming.

King: A man, I hope! A tall and handsome man. Please!

Narrator: Princess June opened the door. The man was indeed tall and handsome. But he was not a prince.

Handsome Man: I understand you are looking for a new gardener.

June: Actually, I'm looking for a prince to marry me.

Narrator: The man was not a prince, but he was charming, kind, and wise.

Handsome Man: Well, now, you are a very beautiful princess. I would be delighted to marry you. Although I am not a prince now, I would be if I married a princess. Marry me and you shall have your prince.

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Narrator: From behind the door, the king, queen, servants, and other princesses said,

King, Queen, Servants, April, May: Take him!

Narrator: And so she did. The next day, the castle was full of flowers and wedding guests. The three princesses were full of happiness; the king and queen were full of pride; the servants were full of relief. It was a marvelous wedding. The three princesses were stunning in their wedding gowns of silk, lace, beads, and jewels. The three princes were dashing in their wedding suits. The feast was delicious. No one went hungry in all the land that day. The dance could not have been better, even though someone dropped a glass slipper. It was a glorious day. As the newlyweds kissed, everyone was certain the three princesses and their princes would live happily ever after. And so they did.

SOURCE INFORMATION

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